



PRINTABLE GUIDED JOURNAL

The Parent I Didn't Have

A journal for grieving someone who was never really
there



*"Write it. Feel it. Heal it.
Your journal knows the real you."*

I LIKE IT DEEP

A note before you begin

This isn't grief for someone who died — it's grief for a relationship that never got the chance to exist. That kind of loss doesn't always get recognized, but it's just as real. You're allowed to mourn the parent you needed and never had.

What do you wish you'd had with them, that you never got?

What's a specific moment you needed them and they weren't there?

What did you tell yourself as a kid to explain their absence?

What do you know now, as an adult, that you didn't understand back then?

Is there a version of them you imagined, versus who they actually were?

What did you have to learn to do on your own, that a parent should've taught you?

How do you think their absence shaped how you love, trust, or show up for people now?

What did you promise yourself you'd never do, because of them?

What's a strength you built directly because of what you didn't have?

What I know about this _____

glue a photo here, or leave blank and write instead

A little about this:

What I know about this _____

glue a photo here, or leave blank and write instead

A little about this:

What I know about this _____

glue a photo here, or leave blank and write instead

A little about this:

What I know about this _____

glue a photo here, or leave blank and write instead

A little about this:

Write them a letter. Say the things you never got the chance to.

What would you want them to understand about what their absence cost you?

Is there anything you'd want to ask them, if you could?

What would it take for you to forgive them — and do you want to?

What's one thing you're proud you became, in spite of what you didn't have?

Who did show up for you, even if it wasn't them?

What do you want to give yourself now, that they never gave you?

Write down one thing you know for sure about your own worth, separate from them.



You didn't need them to prove you were worth
staying for.

That was never about you — it was about them. You get to define
what family means from here.

I LIKE IT DEEP